

30-Minute Student Task

Build Your Own Rule-Based Python Chatbot

YOUR TASK

Build a simple rule-based conversational chatbot in Python. Your chatbot must interact continuously with the user, recognize different messages, provide appropriate responses, and allow the user to exit.

TIME PLAN

Time	Task
0–5 min	Plan your chatbot and decide what it should respond to.
5–20 min	Write and test the chatbot.
20–25 min	Add extra responses and test different inputs.
25–30 min	Clean your code and prepare a quick demonstration.

REQUIREMENTS

1. Ask the user's name before the main conversation.
2. Use **while True:** to keep the conversation running.
3. Use **input()** to receive messages.
4. Clean the input using **.lower().strip()**.
5. Recognize at least two greetings, such as **hello** and **hi**.
6. Answer at least three different questions or topics.
7. Use **if / elif / else** for decision making.
8. Use **break** to exit when the user types **bye** or **exit**.
9. Use the user's name in at least one response.
10. Provide a useful response for unknown messages using **else**.

CHALLENGE

Make your chatbot flexible. Use the **in** operator where appropriate so that variations such as **"hello bot"** or **"hey hello"** can still trigger a greeting.

TEST YOUR CHATBOT

- Test with: hello
- Test with: HELLO
- Test with: hello
- Test with: hi
- Test with: one of your questions
- Test with: an unknown message

■ Test with: bye or exit

FINAL INSTRUCTION

Close your notes and build the chatbot yourself. Do not copy a complete chatbot from the previous example. You may use the concepts you learned, but write the logic yourself.

Target flow: INPUT → PROCESS → RESPOND → REPEAT → EXIT